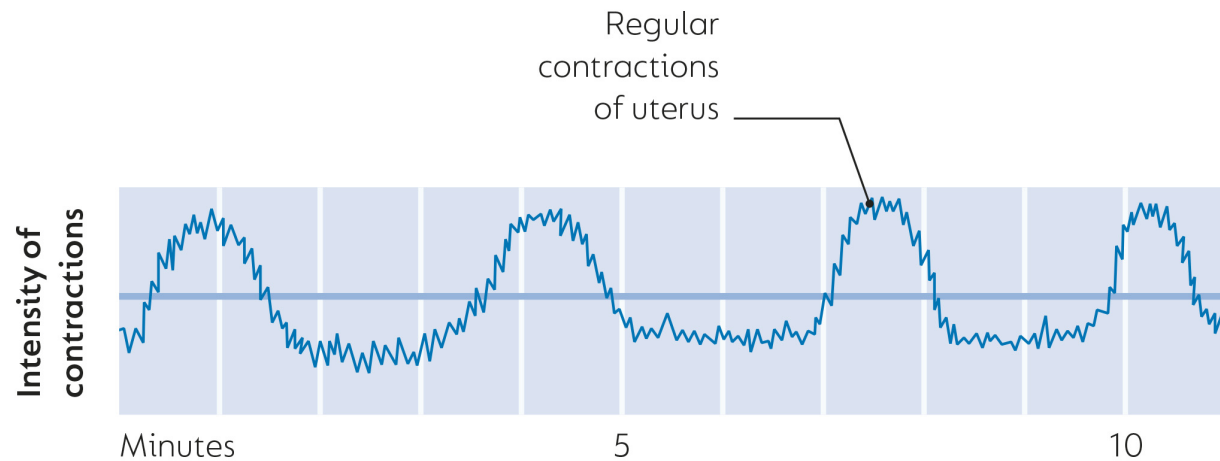




A separate reading records the strength and duration of each contraction. The usual goal is to have 4–5 contractions in 10 minutes; too frequent contractions can cause fetal distress and insufficient contractions can slow labor progress.

INTERNAL MONITORING

If there are concerns about the baby's heartbeat, a small electrode attached to the scalp can give a more precise reading than external electronic fetal monitoring. The electrode is passed through the cervix and attached to the head.